

**SMALLEST
NONBIRD DINOSAUR**

The color of *Epidexipteryx*'s coat probably provided it with camouflage in its forest habitat.

Epidexipteryx's back legs may not have been covered with the fuzzlike feathers.

The animal's sharp teeth formed a scoop in the front of its mouth that helped it gather insects.

Elaborate displays

Epidexipteryx's four tail feathers were probably the same length as the creature's body. Given their size and number and how similar they were to the display feathers of modern birds such as the peacock, they were probably used to impress mates.

STATS AND FACTS

Epidexipteryx is only known from the fossil of one specimen. Weighing around 6 oz (164 g), it was possibly one of the smallest dinosaurs ever. One small theropod that may have been lighter is *Parvicursor*.

TAIL FEATHERS



Epidexipteryx's fossil shows that its tail feathers were at least 7½ in (19 cm) long and may have been brightly colored.

TINY THIGH BONE



At about 2 in (5 cm) in length, *Epidexipteryx*'s thigh bone was around half the size of that of a chicken.

***Epidexipteryx* is the oldest known group of animals to have ornamental tail feathers.**